

LinguaLounge IPA Reference Sheet: Ukrainian

Base language: English - / / = broad phonemic IPA, [] = common phonetic realization.
Regional pronunciation can vary.

Scope

Standard Ukrainian. Unlike Russian, Ukrainian vowels are generally stable and do not undergo strong unstressed reduction.

VOWELS

Category	IPA symbols
Vowels	/a ɛ ɪ ɔ u/
Iotated letters	я /ja/, є /jɛ/, ї /ji/, ю /ju/ word-initially or after vowels/signs
Palatalization marker	ь marks soft consonants; i and iotated vowels often soften previous consonants

CONSONANTS

Category	IPA symbols
Plosives	/p b t d k g/
Fricatives	/f v s z ʃ ʒ x h/
Affricates	/t͡s d͡z t͡ʃ d͡ʒ/
Nasals	/m n/ plus palatalized /nʲ/
Liquids / approximants	/l r j ʋ/ plus palatalized /lʲ rʲ/

ALPHABET AND COMMON SPELLING VALUES

The table gives common learner-safe values. Some letters have additional values in loanwords, names, or regional speech.

Letter / spelling	Main IPA value	Example	Notes
А а	/a/	мама /'mama/	
Б б	/b/	брат /brat/	
В в	/v/; [ʏ] in some positions	вона [ʊɔ'na]	Often [ʏ] before consonants or word-finally.
Г г	/ɦ/	гора /ɦɔ'ra/	Voiced glottal fricative.
Ґ ґ	/g/	ґанок /'ɡanɔk/	Distinct from г.
Д д	/d, dʲ/	дім /dʲim/	
Е е	/ɛ/	сестра /sɛ'stra/	
Є є	/jɛ/ or palatalizing /ɛ/	є /jɛ/, синє /'sɪnʲɛ/	
Ж ж	/ʒ/	жук /ʒuk/	
З з	/z, zʲ/	зима /zɪ'ma/	
И и	/ɪ/	син /sɪn/	Different from і /i/.
І і	/i/	місто /'misto/	
Ї ї	/ji/	їжа /'jiʒa/	
Й й	/j/	мій /mij/	
К к	/k/	кіт /kit/	
Л л	/l, lʲ/	ліс /lʲis/	
М м	/m/	мати /'matɪ/	
Н н	/n, nʲ/	ніс /nʲis/	
О о	/ɔ/	око /'ɔkɔ/	
П п	/p/	поле /'pɔlɛ/	
Р р	/r, rʲ/	ранок /'ranɔk/	
С с	/s, sʲ/	сіль /sʲilʲ/	
Т т	/t, tʲ/	тато /'tatɔ/	
У у	/u/	рука /ru'ka/	
Ф ф	/f/	факт /fakt/	
Х х	/x/	хата /'xata/	
Ц ц	/t͡s, t͡sʲ/	це /t͡sɛ/	
Ч ч	/t͡ʃ/	час /t͡ʃas/	
Ш ш	/ʃ/	школа /'ʃkɔla/	
Щ щ	/ʃt͡ʃ/	щука /'ʃt͡ʃuka/	
Ь ь	no sound; palatalization	сіль /sʲilʲ/	Soft sign.
Ю ю	/ju/ or palatalizing /u/	юнак /ju'nak/, люди /'lʲudɪ/	
Я я	/ja/ or palatalizing /a/	яблуко /'jablukɔ/	

IMPORTANT SPELLING AND PRONUNCIATION NOTES

Stress	Stress is variable and usually not marked in normal spelling. Dictionaries mark it.
Stable vowels	Unstressed vowels remain much clearer than in Russian; do not reduce o to [e] as in Russian.
Apostrophe	The apostrophe separates /j/ and prevents palatalization: п'ять /pjatʲ/.
Soft consonants	ь and the letters я/є/ю/і can mark palatalization of the previous consonant.